SUNDAY 3 MAY 2026
Fifth Sunday of Easter

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

PRIESTS:
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Parish websites *(including access to church webcams)* and emails:
Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com **Email:** aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org
Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com **Email:** drumquin@derrydiocese.org
Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com **Email:** castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR TH5IS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday *4 May*		**Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm:** *First Anniversary: Will Lynch*	**Mass, 10.00am** **Rosary, 8.00pm at Our Lady's Grotto**
Tuesday *5 May*	**Mass, 10.00am**	**Rosary, 2.00pm, each Tuesday of May**	**Rosary, 10.00am**
Wednesday *6 May*	**Liturgy of the Word, with Holy Communion, 10.00am**	**Liturgy of the Word, with Holy Communion, 10.00am**	**Mass, 10.00am**
Thursday *7 May*	**Mass, 10.00am, with Adoration until 12.00noon**		
Friday *8 May*		**Mass, 10.00am, with Adoration until 12.00noon**	
Saturday *9 May*	**Vigil Mass, 7.30pm:**	**Vigil Mass, Castlederg: 6.15pm**	**Vigil Mass: 5.00pm**
Sunday *10 May*	*(Mass on 1st, 3rd & 5th Sunday)*	**Mass: Dregish, 9.30am** **Castlederg, 11.00am** *(Mass on 2nd, 4th & 5th Sunday)* **Drumnabey,12.30pm**	*(Mass on 1st, 3rd & 5th Sunday)*

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:
AGHYARAN: £710 & €54. **Church Restoration Fund** £551 & €30. **DRUMQUIN:** £507.
ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,053 & €98, made up of:
Castlederg £1,220 & €98, **Drumnabey** £375, **Dregish** £458.

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We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Charlie Logue, Castlefin Park, whose Funeral Mass took place in Castlederg on Tuesday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to Charlie's family and to all who mourn his death.

Our prayers are asked for the happy repose of the souls of those recently enrolled in the Derry Diocesan Society:

Aghyaran: Ellen Lynch, Aghamore Road; **Drumquin:** Cameron Donnelly, Riversdale Road;

Ardstraw West and Castlederg: Delma McGlynn, Castlefin Road; Ellen Sweeney, Castlefin Park; Tom McHugh, Killeter Road; Pat Keenan, Churchtown Park; Marrie McMenamin, Castlefin Road; Derek Duggan, Listymore Park; Anne Doherty, Killeter Road; Angela Laird, Castleview Terrace; Doris Gallagher, Een Park; Colleen Vakusic (nee Masterson), Harper Park; Brendan Douglas, Ganvaughan Road.

May they rest in peace.

BLESSING OF THE GRAVES CEREMONIES THIS YEAR:

CASTLEDERG: Saturday 6 June at 6.15pm – Mass followed by Blessing of the Graves.

DRUMNABEY: Sunday 7 June at 12.30pm – Mass followed by Blessing of the Graves.

CARNCORN: Sunday 7 June at 3.00pm – Blessing of the Graves.

DREGISH: Sunday 7 June at 5.00pm – Mass followed by Blessing of the Graves
(Please note, there will be no 9.30am Mass that morning).

AGHYARAN: Saturday 13 June at 6.00pm – Mass followed by Blessing of the Graves
(Please note, there will be no 7.30pm Mass on that evening).

DRUMQUIN: Saturday 20 June at 5.00pm – Mass followed by Blessing of the Graves
(Please note, there will be no Sunday morning Mass that weekend).

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG PARISH DRAW: Congratulations to the winners of the April draw:

£1,000 Kathleen McHugh (212); Promoter's Prize: Mairead McGrath

£500 Joe Elliott (1028)

£250 (x 3) Eoghan McHugh (738); Bronagh Akay (1143); William McCawille (180)

£100 (x 7) Mary Arkinson (12); Sean Baird (1031); Maureen Lynch (674); William Bogle (7); Mairead Arkinson (1001); Grainne McAleer (493); Nan Cassidy (617).

As always, thanks to our wonderful team of promoters and to all who are supporting our Parish Appeal by taking part in the draw. Returns for the May draw should be made to the Parochial House on Thursday 14 May between 6.00 and 7.30pm. The third year of the draw will commence on Sunday 31 May, in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg. If you pay monthly, why not consider paying by Standing Order?
This year again we will have 1,200 tickets maximum. If there is anyone who is not currently in the draw but would like to join, please speak to one of our promoters or contact the parish office. In the event of there being no free numbers available, you will be placed on a waiting list, on a 'first come first served' basis.

SINCERE THANKS to all who came along – from near and far - to the parish fundraising 25 Card Play in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg, last Friday night. There was a great atmosphere in the hall, and the 'tea ladies' are to be commended, once again, for their superb hospitality; sincere thanks also to those who provided such lovely food for the occasion. Congratulations to the winners! Thanks to all who took part in the 'unplayed tickets' draw and also to everyone who gave prizes for the raffle, all of which added to the social and financial success of the night. Huge thanks to John Coyle for organising the Card Play, which raised an amazing **£2,020 and €145**! Thank you, as always, to Dave for all his work in the background, to Eugene for his help, and to our MC, Leslie, who kept everyone right on the night. Well done to one and all!

LEGION OF MARY Meeting will take place in the Parochial House, Drumquin, this Wednesday, 6 May, at 7.30pm.

PARISH PRAYER GROUP – You are invited to join the Ardstraw West & Castlederg Parish Prayer Group in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg (kitchen area) on the second and fourth Fridays of the month, at 8.00pm, for Prayer, Rosary and Scripture reading of the Sunday Gospel. In May the dates will be Friday 8 and Friday 22.

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Wednesday 6 May - Young Crescent and Drumnabey, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Thomas
Thursday 7 May - Castlederg Rural Area, commencing at 11.15am - Fr Paul
Friday 8 May - Castlederg Town commencing at 11am - Fr Thomas
Friday 8 May - Dregish commencing at 2.00pm - Fr Paul.

TALK ON 'OUR LADY, OUR MOTHER': Mgr Barney McAleer, retired SMA priest, will give a Talk this Thursday, 7 May, in the Pastoral Centre, Brook Street, Omagh at 8.00pm. All are welcome.

KNOCK PILGRIMAGE to Pray for Peace in the Holy Land: People from all over Ireland are invited to Knock Shrine on Saturday 16 May, for a special pilgrimage to pray for peace in the Holy Land. The pilgrimage – organised by the papal charity Aid to the Church in Need – will be led by Bishop William Shomali from Bethlehem. Bishop Shomali will offer a message of hope at 11am, and celebrate Mass at 3pm. All are welcome. More information at www.acnireland.org

DERRY DIOCESAN PILGRIMAGE TO KNOCK SHRINE will take place on Saturday 6 June. In conjunction with the All-Ireland Rosary Rally, the pilgrimage will join those gathered to celebrate at our National Marian Shrine.

DROMORE SUNRISE WALK: Annual walk takes place this Saturday, 9 May, at 4.15am from Dromore Sports Complex raising funds for **AWARE NI**. Join us as we walk together from darkness into light, followed by refreshments in the Sports Complex. Donations collected on the morning.